

Linux kernel 3.2.61 LTS officially released

The launch of the Linux kernel 3.2.61 LTS, the brand-new maintenance release of the 3.2 kernel series, has been officially announced by Ben Hutchings, the maintainer of the Linux 2.6 kernel branch. While highlighting the slew of changes that come bundled along with the latest release, Hutchings advised users to upgrade to it as early as possible.

The Linux kernel 3.2.61 is an important release in the cycle, according to Hutchings. It introduces better support for the x86, ARM, PowerPC, s390 and MIPS architectures. At the same time, it also improves support for the EXT4, ReiserFS, Btrfs, NFS and UBIFS file systems. It also comes with updated drivers for wireless connectivity, InfiniBand, USB, ACPI, Bluetooth, SCSI, Radeon and Intel i915, among others.

Meanwhile, Linux founder Linus Torvalds has officially announced the fifth Release Candidate (RC) version of the upcoming Linux kernel 3.16. The RC5 is a successor to Linux 3.16-rc4. It is now available for download and testing. However, since it is a development version, it should not be installed on production machines.

Motorola brings out Android 4.4.4 KitKat upgrade for Moto E, Moto G and Moto X

Motorola has unveiled the Android 4.4.4 KitKat update for its devices in India, for Moto E, Moto G and Moto X. This latest version of Android has an extra layer of security for browsing Web content on the phone.

With this phased rollout, users will receive notifications that will enable them to update their OS but, alternatively, the update can also be accessed by way of the settings menu. This release goes on to shore up Motorola's commitment to offering its customers a pure, bloatware-free and seamless Android experience.

With the Android One platform, Google aims to reach the 5 billion people across the world who still do not own a smartphone. According to Pichai, less than 10 per cent of the world's population owns smartphones in emerging countries. The promise of a stock Android experience at a low price point is what Android One aims to provide. Home-grown manufacturers such as Micromax, Karbonn and Spice will create and sell these Android One phones for which hardware reference points, software and subsequent updates will be provided by Google. Even though the spec sheet of Android One phones hasn't been officially released, Micromax is already working on its next low budget phone, which many believe will be an Android One device.

SQL injection vulnerability patched in Ruby on Rails

Two SQL injection vulnerabilities were patched in Ruby on Rails, which is an open source Web development framework now used by many developers. Some high profile websites also use this framework. The Ruby on Rails developers recently launched versions 3.2.19, 4.0.7 and 4.1.3, and advised users to upgrade to these versions as soon as possible. And a few hours later, they again released versions 4.0.8 and 4.1.4 to fix problems caused by the 4.0.7 and 4.1.3 updates.

One of the two SQL injection vulnerabilities affects applications running on Ruby versions 2.0.0 through to 3.2.18, which also use the PostgreSQL database system and query bit string data types. Another vulnerability affects applications running on Ruby on Rails versions 4.0.0 to 4.1.2, which use PostgreSQL and querying range data types.

Despite affecting different versions, these two flaws are related and allow attackers to inject arbitrary SQL code using crafted values.

The city of Munich adopts Linux in a big way!

It's certainly not a case of an overnight conversion. The city of Munich began to seek open source alternatives way back in 2003.



With a population of about 1.5 million citizens and thousands of employees, this German city took its time to adopt open source. Tens of thousands of government workstations were to be considered for the change. Its initial shopping list had suitably rigid specifications, spanning everything from avoiding vendor lock-in and receiving regular hardware support updates, to having access to an expansive range of free applications.

In its first stage of migration, in 2006, Debian was introduced across a small percentage of government workstations, with the remaining Windows computers switching to OpenOffice.org, followed by Firefox and Thunderbird.

Debian was substituted for a custom Ubuntu-based distribution named 'LiMux' in 2008, after the team handling the project 'realised Ubuntu was the platform that could satisfy our requirements best.'